

DOCUMENT 36

SPONSORSHIP PROPOSAL BUILDER & CUSTOM PROPOSAL TRAINING GUIDE

How to Turn “Send Us a Proposal” Into a Professional, Customized Partnership Opportunity

Purpose: Train Student Fellows and leadership to prepare a tailored sponsorship proposal after a qualified prospect requests one. The proposal should reflect what was learned in discovery, make a clear ask, explain the proposed use and include only benefits and facts that have been approved.

THE RULE: DO NOT SEND EVERY COMPANY THE SAME PROPOSAL

A bank, airline, technology company, university, media company and local business should not receive identical proposals. The core program story can remain consistent, but the fit, ask, proposed activation and approved recognition should be customized to the organization.

1. WHEN TO BUILD A CUSTOM PROPOSAL

Build?	Situation
YES	Prospect specifically asks for a proposal or sponsorship options.
YES	Discovery meeting identifies a real budget, contribution pathway or decision process.
YES	Decision-maker requests a written recommendation for internal review.
YES	Organization is considering a specific in-kind contribution requiring written scope.
NO	Cold prospect has never engaged and has not requested a proposal.
NO	Only an automated response or generic 'send information' has been received.
NO	The team has not yet determined what to ask for or why the organization fits.

2. INFORMATION TO COLLECT BEFORE WRITING

Input	What Must Be Known
Organization	Correct legal/brand name and relevant division.
Contact	Name, title, department and role in the decision.
What they told us	Priorities, geography, audience, budget timing and questions.
Primary ask	Exact cash amount or defined in-kind contribution.
Secondary ask	Alternative pathway if the primary ask cannot be approved.
Program use	How the proposed contribution would support approved program needs.
Recognition	Only benefits leadership has approved.
Decision process	Who approves, deadline, budget cycle and requested format.
Proof / facts	Only verified current program facts, dates, eligibility and confirmed partners.
Next step	What action we want after they read the proposal.

3. RECOMMENDED PROPOSAL STRUCTURE

#	Section	Purpose
1	Customized Cover	Organization name + proposed partnership title + Student Impact Challenge.
2	Executive Summary	One short page/section explaining the opportunity and exact ask.
3	About the Challenge	What students do, who is eligible, purpose and verified timeline.
4	Why This Organization	Specific alignment based on research/discovery.
5	Proposed Partnership	The contribution being requested and what it would support.
6	Impact / Use	Clear explanation of intended program use; avoid unsupported outcome claims.
7	Recognition / Benefits	Only approved, deliverable benefits appropriate to the contribution.
8	Activation Ideas	Optional ways the partner can engage through approved experiences, mentors, media, products, etc.
9	Timeline & Next Steps	Decision date, program timing and proposed follow-up.
10	Contact	Leadership/program contact information.

4. WRITING THE EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The executive summary should answer four questions quickly: **What is the Student Impact Challenge? Why does this organization fit? What exactly are we asking for? What would the support enable?**

Internal formula: Program + Alignment + Specific Ask + Intended Use + Next Step.

Example framework: "The Student Impact Challenge invites eligible students to engage with businesses and communities, identify real problems and propose solutions. Based on [Company]'s stated commitment to [priority], we are proposing a \$25,000 partnership to support [approved use]. We welcome the opportunity to review the proposal with your team and determine the strongest path forward."

5. CUSTOMIZATION BY SPONSOR TYPE

Scenario	Positioning	Alignment	Primary Ask	Possible Use
\$5K Local Business	Community Sponsor	Local student/community support	\$5,000	Local programming, awards or outreach
\$25K Corporate	Impact Partner	Youth/community alignment	\$25,000	Student programming, awards, scholarships or outreach
\$50K Technology	Leadership Partner	STEM/AI/innovation	\$50,000 + optional technology	Innovation/STEM programming, awards, devices, mentors
\$100K+ Major	Major Partnership	Transformational alignment	\$100,000+ discussion	Major program or scholarship support; leadership-negotiated
Airline	Travel Partner	Travel + aviation careers	Airfare / travel certificates	Approved travel awards/experiences + career exposure
Hotel / Resort	Experience Partner	Hospitality + teacher recognition	Stay package / resort experience	Approved teacher/winner experience
Media Company	Awareness Partner	Student/family reach	Donated media inventory	Recruitment and public awareness
Retailer	Prize / Community Partner	Families + products	Products/gift cards + cash	Student prizes, supplies, community activation
University	Education Partner	Education + careers	Scholarships / campus experiences	Scholarship opportunity, campus exposure, mentors

6. AI PROPOSAL DRAFTING WORKFLOW

AI may help create a **first draft**, but it must never invent facts, partners, statistics, commitments, benefits or company priorities. The fellow provides verified inputs; AI organizes and drafts; the fellow fact-checks; leadership approves before sending.

MASTER AI PROMPT TEMPLATE

Create a professional sponsorship proposal draft for the Student Impact Challenge. Prospect: [ORGANIZATION]. Contact/department: [CONTACT]. What they told us: [DISCOVERY NOTES]. Their relevant priority: [PRIORITY]. Primary ask: [AMOUNT OR IN-KIND ASK]. Secondary ask: [ALTERNATIVE]. Proposed use: [APPROVED USE]. Approved recognition/benefits: [BENEFITS]. Verified program facts only: [FACTS]. Desired next step: [NEXT STEP]. Keep the tone concise, credible and partnership-focused. Do not invent statistics, partners, outcomes, benefits, exclusivity, naming rights, celebrity involvement, tax claims or commitments. Clearly distinguish confirmed facts from proposed opportunities.

7. AI PROMPT EXAMPLES

Prospect	AI Drafting Instruction
Regional Bank	Draft a proposal requesting \$25,000 to support student awards and entrepreneurship/community problem-solving programming. The bank told us financial literacy and youth opportunity are priorities. Secondary ask: financial-education speakers and scholarship support.
Technology Company	Draft a \$50,000 STEM/innovation partnership proposal. Secondary ask: laptops, software and employee mentors. Do not promise branding or data access beyond approved benefits.
Airline	Draft an in-kind proposal requesting approved airfare/travel certificates for program winners/teachers. Secondary ask: aviation-career experiences and cash support. Include no travel promise until confirmed.
Media Company	Draft an awareness partnership requesting donated advertising inventory to reach eligible students and families. Secondary ask: interviews/PSAs where editorially appropriate. Do not promise coverage.
University	Draft an education partnership requesting scholarship support, campus experiences and mentors. Do not describe scholarships as confirmed until the institution approves them.

8. FACT-CHECK BEFORE LEADERSHIP REVIEW

- Correct organization and contact name.
- All program dates, eligibility and rules match approved current materials.
- Every participation/statistical claim is verified and current.
- Only confirmed partners/sponsors are described as partners/sponsors.
- Requested amount/in-kind contribution matches the meeting notes.
- Proposed use is feasible and approved.
- Benefits are approved; no invented naming rights or exclusivity.
- No promise of student/participant data or direct access to minors.
- No guaranteed media, attendance, impressions, celebrity participation or outcomes.
- No unsupported tax/legal claims.
- All links, emails and phone numbers are correct.
- Proposal has a clear next step and owner.

9. WHAT FELLOWS MAY AND MAY NOT DO

Fellows may: research, collect discovery notes, prepare the proposal brief, use approved AI prompts to draft, proofread, fact-check and submit the draft for leadership review. **Fellows may not:** sign agreements, change sponsorship benefits, promise exclusivity/naming rights, negotiate legal terms, promise data/media/celebrity access, or send an unapproved custom proposal for a major opportunity.

10. PROPOSAL STATUS IN THE CRM

Status	Meaning
Proposal Requested	Prospect asked for a written proposal.
Drafting	Fellow/leadership preparing the proposal.
Leadership Review	Facts, ask, benefits and terms being approved.
Sent	Proposal delivered; record date/version.

Status	Meaning
Under Review	Prospect evaluating internally.
Revision Requested	Prospect requested changes; leadership reviews changes.
Verbal / Written Intent	Specific support discussed subject to final process.
Confirmed	Required approval/agreement/payment or in-kind confirmation completed.
Nurture / Future Cycle	Fit exists but timing/budget is later.
Closed - No	Opportunity declined or no longer viable.

11. PROPOSAL QUALITY STANDARD

A strong proposal should be easy to understand in five minutes. It should not be 25 pages of generic information. The prospect should immediately understand the program, why the opportunity fits them, what is being requested, what the support would enable and what happens next.

12. AFTER THE PROPOSAL IS SENT

Record the sent date and exact version in the CRM. Send it to the person who requested it. Confirm receipt when appropriate. Follow the timing they gave you; if none was given, establish a reasonable follow-up date. When the prospect responds, move back into the Document 34 meeting/closing process. If the proposal is accepted, begin formal confirmation and sponsor-fulfillment planning.

PROGRAM CONTACT

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